Project: *White Lie*

Engine: Unity

Platform: PC (browser)

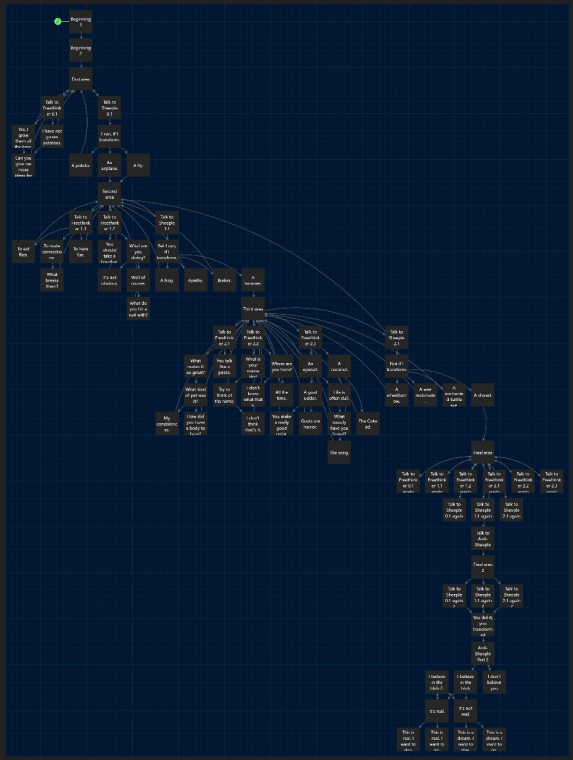
Genre: Adventure

Summary: This game was made at the MacEwan Game Dev Club Game Jam 2026, with several fellow students. The theme was “shifting”, and so we used that idea for a game where you can speak certain words in order to shapeshift.

Game Design: The game design was a collaborative effort, though I eventually became the one responsible for decisions regarding the details and game feel.

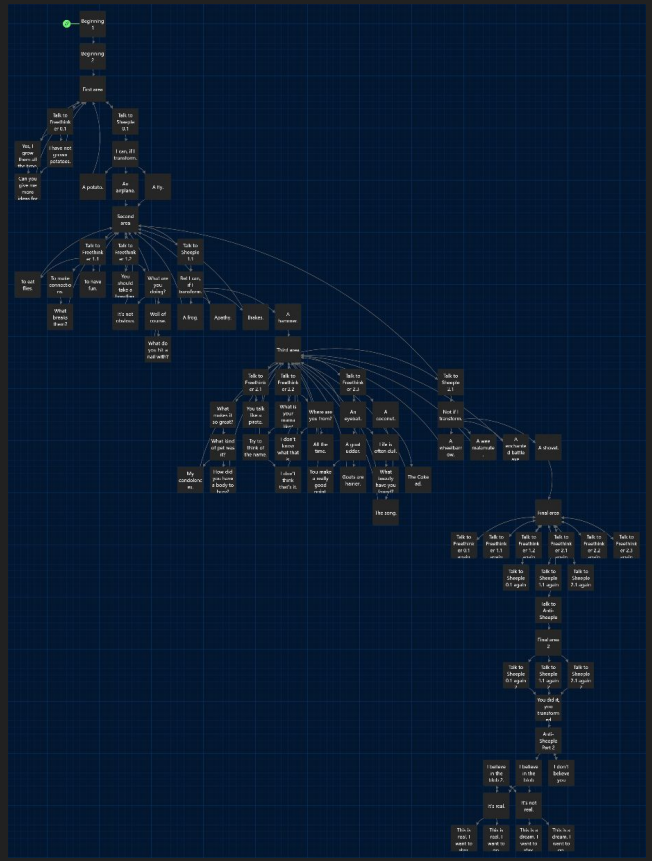
Narrative Design: I was the sole writer. I used Twine to prototype the game's branching dialogue trees, before we started adding them to Unity. Since speech was the main mechanic of the game, there were approximately 100 different interactions and dialogues in the game.

Programming: I also stepped in to help with programming, such as scripting the UI for the main menu and establishing the camera boundaries.



*Zoomed-out Twine dialogue tree.*

# Planning



*Closer look at the Twine dialogue tree.*

Protagonist - A colorful vector guy. He can transform by convincing Sheeple that he can, but he needs ideas from the Freethinkers first. He gains them by talking to them until they bring up the word themselves in conversation.

- Full Transformation List: Potato, fly, airplane, frog, apathy, brakes, hammer, puppy, sarmale, wheelbarrow, shovel, battle axe

Freethinker 0.1 - A cheerful gardener.

- Ideas: Potato, fly, airplane

Sheeple 0.1 - A gullible person.

- Correct Idea: Fly or airplane to cross the pit.

Freethinker 1.1 - A depressed nihilist.

- Ideas: Frog, apathy

Freethinker 1.2 - A stressed out workaholic.

- Ideas: Brakes, hammer

Sheeple 1.1 - A skeptical person.

- Correct Idea: Hammer to break the rock.

Freethinker 2.1 - A cantankerous pirate.

- Ideas: Puppy

Freethinker 2.2 - A blunt Balkan person.

- Ideas: Sarmale, wheelbarrow, shovel

Freethinker 2.3 - An old-timey knight.

- Ideas: Battle axe

Sheeple 2.1 - A pretty convinced person.

- Correct Idea: Shovel to dig under the force field.

Anti-Sheeple - A totally convinced person. You try all of your ideas, but they don't believe you. So you go up to the Sheeple, and transform at least once to prove yourself. The Anti-Sheeple is shocked and wants to try, so he asks if you believe that he can turn into a blob. Say yes to transform him, and he's so happy. Say no, and he calls you a hypocrite. Then he asks what else you believe: is this reality or a dream? Do you want to live in a dream?

*Notes on which characters are which, including their unique personalities.*